



A SURGE IN SPIRIT AND AN AWAKENING IN INTELLIGENCE

THE FOUNDING OF BAGHDAD (762)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Islamic society and science

BEFORE

711 A Muslim Arab and Berber army conquers the Visigothic Kingdom of Spain.

756 Umayyad prince Abd al-Rahman I establishes a court at Cordoba in Spain.

AFTER

800 The first Islamic hospital is established in Baghdad.

825 Al-Khwarizmi introduces decimal notation (derived from India) to the Islamic world.

1138–1154 Al-Idrisi compiles a world map for Roger II of Sicily.

1258 The sack of Baghdad marks the end of the Abbasid caliphate.

1259 An astronomical observatory is founded at Maragha.

In 762, the second ruler of the newly ascendant Abbasid dynasty moved the capital of the powerful Islamic Caliphate from Damascus to the newly-founded city of Baghdad. The move is often seen as marking the beginning of an Islamic golden age in which science, art, and culture flourished. The extent of Muslim technological development was demonstrated in 802

Islamic conquests result in many collections of **Greek manuscripts** being held in **Arab-controlled areas**.



Al-Mansur founds Baghdad and the city becomes a center of Muslim science and learning.



Translation of Greek scientific texts in the **House of Wisdom** in Baghdad leads to **Arab scientific advances**.



Arabic translations of Greek authors appear in Europe where they are **translated into Latin**, so diffusing knowledge of lost classical texts.

when the Abbasid caliph Harun al-Rashid dispatched an embassy to the Frankish ruler, Charlemagne, which included the gift of a water clock that chimed the hours by dropping brass balls onto cymbals at the mechanism's base. This sophisticated timepiece was just one of the advances the Arabs had made—advances that left their European counterparts far behind.

The rise of the Abbasids

After the death of the Prophet Muhammad in 632, his successors ruled over a growing Islamic empire (or caliphate). Following the